

0.0.1 Makhadeva

1. Thus was heard by me: At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Mithila, in the Makhadeva Mango Grove. It so happened that the Auspicious One displayed a smile at a certain spot. Then of the venerable Ananda, this occurred: “What is the cause? What is the reason for the Auspicious One’s displaying of a smile? Tathagatas do not display a smile without a cause.” Then the venerable Ananda, having arranged his robe on one shoulder, having stretched out his hands in anjali towards the Auspicious One, said this to the Auspicious One: “What, O Bhante, is the cause? What is the reason for the Auspicious One’s displaying of a smile? Tathagatas do not display a smile without a cause.”

2. Once upon a time, O Ananda, in just this Mithila, there was a king named Makhadeva, a righteous, lawful king who stood firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and he observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.

3. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Makhadeva addressed his barber: “when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform

0.0.1 makhādevasuttam

1. evaṃ me sutam: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā mithilāyaṃ viharati makhādevambavane. atha kho bhagavā aññatarasmiṃ padese sitaṃ pātvākāsi. atha kho āyasmato ānandassa etadahosi: ko nu kho hetu, ko paccayo bhagavato sitassa pātukammāya? na akāraṇe tathāgatā sitaṃ pātukarontī'ti. atha kho āyasmā ānando ekaṃsaṃ cīvaraṃ katvā yena bhagavā tenañjalimpaṇāmetvā bhagavantam etadavoca: ko nu kho bhante hetu, ko paccayo bhagavato sitassa pātukammāya? na akāraṇe² tathāgatā sitaṃ pātukarontī'ti.

2. bhūtapubbaṃ ānanda, imissāyeva mithilāyaṃ rājā ahosi makhādevo³ nāma dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme t̥hito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapati-kesu negamesu⁴ cepi jānapadesu ca. uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasim aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassa.

3. atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo bahunnaṃ⁵ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ accayena kappakaṃ āmantesi: 'yadā me samma kappaka, passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni⁶ jātāni, atha me āroceyyāsi'ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa paccassosi. addasā kho ānanda, kappako bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ accayena rañño makhādevassa sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni. disvāna rājānaṃ makhādevaṃ etadavoca: pātubhūtā kho devassa devadūtā, dissanti sirasmiṃ palitāni⁶ jātāni'ti. tena

me.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber replied to king Makhadeva. Then from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, O Ananda, the barber saw that grey hairs have emerged on king Makhadeva’s head. Having seen, he said this to king Makhadeva: “The divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on your head.” “Well then good barber, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in my cupped hand.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber having replied to king Makhadeva, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in king Makhadeva’s cupped hand.

4. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: “My son prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, having shaved off

hi samma kappaka, tāni palitāni sādhuṇaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā mama⁷ añjalismiṃ patitṭhāpehī'ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa paṭissutvā tāni palitāni sādhuṇaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā rañño makhādevassa añjalismiṃ patitṭhāpesi.

4. atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo kappakassa gā-mavaraṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ āmantāpetvā etadavoca: pātubhūtā kho me tāta kumāra devadūtā, dissanti sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, bhuttā kho pana me mānusakā kāmā, samayo dibbe kāme pariyesituṃ. ehi tvaṃ tāta kumāra, imaṃ rajjaṃ paṭipajja. ahaṃ pana kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajissāmi. tena hi tāta kumāra, yadā tvampi passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, atha kappakassa gāmavaraṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ sādhuṇaṃ rajje samanussāsivā kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ¹ nihitaṃ anuppavatteyyāsi. mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahosi. yasmiṃ kho tāta kumāra, purisa-yuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa samucchetho hoti so tesam antimapuriso hoti. taṃ tāhaṃ tāta kumāra, evaṃ vadāmi: yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahosī'ti.

5. atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo kappakassa gāmavaraṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ sādhuṇaṃ rajje samanussāsivā imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane ke-

hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you my son prince, say thus: "Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man."

5. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kindom, in this Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading

samassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agā-rasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbaji. so mettāsahagatena cet-sasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, ta-thā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ,² iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam mettāsa-hagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi. karuṇāsahaga-tena cetasā -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upek-khāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, ta-thā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ² iti ud-dhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvan-tam lokam upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena ma-haggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena phari-tvā vihāsi.

6. rājā kho panānanda, makhādevo caturāsītivassa-sahassāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīli, caturāsītivassasahassāni oparajjam³ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjam kā-resi, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva makhāde-vambavane agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajito brahma-cariyaṃ cari. so cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kā-yassa bhedaṃ parammaraṇā brahmalokūpago ahosi.

7. atha kho ānanda, rañño makhādevassa putto ba-hunnam vassānam bahunnam vassasatānam bahun-nam vassasahassānam accayena kappakaṃ āmantesi: ‘yadā me samma kappaka, passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ pali-tāni jātāni, atha me āroceyyāsi’ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa puttassa pac-cassosi. addasā kho ānanda, kappako bahunnam vas-

with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

6. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Makhadeva amused himself with children games. For eighty four thousand years he occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on to the brahma world.

7. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Makhadeva's son addressed his barber: "when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform me." "Yes, your majesty," O Ananda, the barber replied to king Makhadeva's son. Then from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, O Ananda, the barber saw that grey hairs have emerged on king Makhadeva's son's head. Having seen, he said this to king Makhadeva's son: "The divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on your head." "Well then good barber, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in my cupped hand." "Yes, your majesty," O Ananda, the

sānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasa-
hassānaṃ accayena rañño makhādevassa puttassa si-
rasmiṃ palitāni jātāni. disvāna rañño makhādevassa
puttaṃ etadavoca: ‘pātubhūtā kho devassa devadūtā,
dissanti sirasmiṃ palitāni jātānī’ti. tena hi samma
kappaka, tāni palitāni sādhukaṃ saṇḍāsena uddhari-
tvā mama añjalismiṃ patiṭṭhāpehī’ti. evaṃ devāti kho
ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa puttassa paṭi-
sutvā tāni palitāni sādhukaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā
rañño makhādevassa puttassa añjalismiṃ patiṭṭhāpesi.

8. atha kho ānanda, rañño makhādevassa putto kap-
pakassa gāmaṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ āman-
tāpetvā etadavoca: ‘pātubhūtā kho me tāta kumāra
devadūtā, dissanti sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, bhuttā kho
pana me mānusakā kāmā, samayo dibbe kāme pariye-
situm. ehi tvaṃ tāta kumāra, imaṃ rajjaṃ paṭipajja.
ahaṃ pana kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni
acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajissāmi. tena
hi tāta kumāra, yadā tvampi passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ pa-
litāni jātāni, atha kappakassa gāmaṃ datvā jeṭ-
ṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ sādhukaṃ rajje samanūsāsivā
kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā
agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idaṃ
kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho
me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahoṣi. yasmiṃ kho tāta ku-
māra, purisayuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa
vaṭṭassa samucchedo hoti, so tesam antimapuriso hoti.
taṃ tāhaṃ tāta kumāra, evaṃ vadāmi: yena me idaṃ
kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho

barber having replied to king Makhadeva's son, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in king Makhadeva's son's cupped hand.

8. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva's son, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: "My son prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved of hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you my son prince, say thus: "Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man."

me tvam antimapuriso ahosī'ti.

9. atha kho ānanda, rañño makhādevassa putto kapakassa gāmavaram datvā jeṭṭhaputtam kumāram sādhuḥkaṃ rajje samanūsāsītvā imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbaji. so mettāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya¹ sabbāvantam lokam mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi.

10. rañño kho panānanda, makhādevassa putto caturāsītivassasahassāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīlī, caturāsītivassasahassāni oparajjam kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjam kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajito brahmacariyaṃ cari. so cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedaṃ parammaraṇā brahmalokūpago ahosi.

9. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva's son having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kindom, in this Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

10. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Makhadeva's son amused himself with children games. For eighty four thousand years he occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of pu-

11. rañño kho panānanda, makhādevassa puttappa-puttakā² tassa paramparā caturāsītikhattiyasahassāni³ imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajimsu. te mettāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihariṃsu, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ.⁴ iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihariṃsu. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihariṃsu. tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihariṃsu.

12. te caturāsītivassasahassāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīlīṃsu, caturāsītivassasahassāni oparajjam¹ kāresuṃ, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjam kāresuṃ, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajitā brahmacariyaṃ carīṃsu. te cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedaṃ parammaṇā brahmalokūpagā ahesuṃ.

13. nimi tesam rājā rājānam² pacchimako ahosi dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme t̥hito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcada-

riety. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on to the brahma world.

11. The sons of sons of king Makhadeva, O Ananda, eighty four thousand kattiyas in succession, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, they dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, they dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

12. For eighty four thousand years [as children] they amused themselves with children games. For eighty four thousand years they occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years they ruled the kingdom.

siṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassa. bhūtapubbaṃ ānanda, devānaṃ tāvatiṃsānaṃ sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ sannisinnānaṃ sannipatitānaṃ ayamantarākathā udapādi: ‘lābhā vata bho videhānaṃ, suladdhaṃ vata bho videhānaṃ, yesaṃ nimi rājā dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme ṭhito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasīṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassā’ti.

14. atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo deve tāvatiṃse āmantesi: ‘iccheyyātha no tumhe mārīsā, nimim rājānaṃ daṭṭhunti icchāma mayaṃ mārīsa, nimim rājānaṃ daṭṭhunti. tena kho pana samayena nimi rājā tadahuposathe pannarase sasīsaṃ nahāto³ uposathiko upari pāsādavaragato nisinno hoti. atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo seyyathāpi nāma balavā puriso sammiñjitaṃ vā bāhaṃ pasāreyya, pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ sammiñjeyya, evamevaṃ devesu tāvatiṃsesu antarahito nimissa rañño pamukhe pāturahosi.

15. atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo nimim rājānaṃ etadavoca: ‘lābhā te mahārāja, suladdhaṃ te mahārāja. devā te mahārāja, tāvatiṃsā sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ kittayamānarūpā sannisinnā: ‘lābhā vata bho videhānaṃ, suladdhaṃ vata bho videhānaṃ, yesaṃ nimi rājā dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme ṭhito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasīṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassā’ti. devā te mahārāja, tāvatiṃsā dassanakāmā, tassa te ahaṃ

For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, they went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, they fared on to the brahma world.

13. King Nimi was the last of those kings, a righteous, lawful king who stood firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and he observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight. Once upon a time, O Ananda, the Tavatimsa devas, having assembled at the Sudhamma hall, this topic of conversation arose as they settled: “It is a gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, it is a good gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, lawful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.”

14. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed the Tavatimsa devas: Do you, dear sirs, wish to see king Nimi? We, dear sir, wish to see king Nimi. At that time, on the fifteenth day of the lunar fortnight, that being the uposatha day, king Nimi having washed his head, having gone to the upper floor of his lofty palace, was seated observing the uposatha. Then, O Ananda, just

mahārāja, saḥassayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ paḥiṇissāmi, abhiruḥeyyāsi mahārāja, dibbaṃ yānaṃ avikampamāno'ti. adhiṇṇāsesi kho ānanda, nimi rājā tuṇḥibhāvena. atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo nimissa rañño adhi-
vāsanaṃ viditvā seyyathāpi nāma balavā puriso sa-
miñjitaṃ vā bāhaṃ pasāreyya, pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ
samiñjeyya, evamevaṃ nimissa rañño pamukhe anta-
rahito devesu tāvatimṣesu pāturahosi.

16. atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo mātalisāṅ-
gāhakaṃ āmantesi: ehi tvaṃ samma mātali, saḥas-
sayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ yojetvā nimim rājānaṃ upa-
saṅkamitvā evaṃ vadesi: 'ayaṃ te mahārāja, saḥas-
sayutto ājaññaratho sakkena devānamindena pesito.
abhiruḥeyyāsi mahārāja, dibbaṃ yānaṃ avikampamāno'ti.
evaṃ bhaddantavāti¹ kho ānanda, mātali saṅgāhako
sakkassa devānamindassa paṭissutvā saḥassayuttaṃ
ājaññarathaṃ yojetvā nimim rājānaṃ upasaṅkamitvā
etadavoca: 'ayaṃ te mahārāja, saḥassayutto ājañña-
ratho sakkena devānamindena pesito, abhiruha ma-
hārāja, dibbaṃ yānaṃ avikampamāno. api ca mahā-
rāja, katamena taṃ nemi, yena vā pāpakammā pāpa-
kānaṃ kammānaṃ vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvedenti, yena vā
kalyāṇakammā kalyāṇānaṃ kammānaṃ vipākaṃ paṭi-
saṃvedenti'ti? ubhayeneva maṃ mātali nehīti. sam-
pāpesi² kho ānanda, mātalisāṅgāhako nimim rājānaṃ
sudhammaṃ sabhaṃ.³ addasā kho ānanda, sakko de-
vānamindo nimim rājānaṃ dūratova āgacchantaṃ. di-
svāna nimim rājānaṃ etadavoca: ehi kho mahārāja,
svāgataṃ⁴ mahārāja, devā te⁵ mahārāja, tāvatimṣā

as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so Sakka, ruler of the devas, disappeared among the Tavatimsa devas and appeared in front of king Nimi.

15. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, said this to king Nimi: “It is a gain for you, great king, it is a good gain for you, great king. The Tavatimsa devas, O great king, having assembled at the Sudhamma assembly hall, are singing your praises as they settled: “It is a gain indeed sirs for the videhans, it is a good gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, lawful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.” We the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, wish to see you. I, O great king, will send a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses for you. Climb aboard that divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation.” King Nimi, O Ananda, consented by silence. So then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, having known of king Nimi’s consent, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so Sakka, ruler of the devas, disappeared in front of king Nimi and appeared among the Tavatimsa devas.

16. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed Matali, the charioteer: “Come you good Matali,

sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ kittayamānarūpā sannisinnā: ‘lābhā vata bho videhānaṃ, suladdhaṃ vata⁶ bho videhānaṃ, yesaṃ nimi rājā dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme t̥hito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca. uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasiṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassā’ti. devā te mahārāja, tāvatimsā dassanakāmā, abhirama mahārāja, devesu devānubhāvenā’ti. alaṃ mārisa, tattheva maṃ mithilaṃ paṭinetu. tatthāhaṃ dhammaṃ carissāmi brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasissāmi cātuddasiṃ pañcadasiṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassā’ti. atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo mātali saṅgāhakaṃ āmantesi: ehi tvaṃ samma mātali, saḥassayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ yojetvā nimim rājānaṃ tattheva mithilaṃ paṭinehīti. evaṃ bhaddantavāti kho ānanda, mātali saṅgāhako sakkassa devānamindassa paṭissutvā saḥassayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ yojetvā nimim rājānaṃ tattheva mithilaṃ paṭinesī.

17. tatra sudam ānanda, nimi rājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasiṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassa. atha kho ānanda, nimi rājā bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ⁷ accayena kappakaṃ āmantesi: ‘yadā me samma kappaka, passeyyāsi sirasmim palitāni jātāni, atha me āroceyyāsi’ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako nimissa rañño paccassosi. addasā kho ānanda, kappako bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatā-

having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, having approached king Nimi, you say thus: "This chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, O great king, has been sent by Sakka, ruler of the devas, for you. Climb aboard the divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation." "Yes Lord," O Ananda, Matali, the charioteer, having replied to Sakka, ruler of the devas, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, having approached king Nimi, said thus: "This chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, O great king, has been sent by Sakka, ruler of the devas, for you. Climb aboard the divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation." "But great king, by what [route do you prefer to be] led by me? That by which those who do evil kamma experience the results of their evil kamma or that by which those who do good kamma experience the results of their good kamma?" "Just lead me, O Matali, by both." Matali, the charioteer, O Ananda, led king Nimi to Sudhamma assembly hall. Sakka, ruler of the devas, O Ananda, saw king Nimi approaching from afar. Having seen, he said this to king Nimi: "Come great king, welcome great king, the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, having assembled at the Sudhamma assembly hall, are singing your praises as they settled: "It is a gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, it is a good gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, lawful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Household-ers, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the

naṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ accayena nimissa rañño sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni. disvāna nimim rājānaṃ etadavoca: pātubhūtā kho devassa devadūtā, disanti sirasmiṃ palitāni jātānī'ti. tena hi samma kappaka, tāni palitāni sādhuṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā mama añjalismiṃ patitṭhāpehī'ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako nimissa rañño paṭissutvā tāni palitāni sādhuṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā nimissa rañño añjalismiṃ patitṭhāpesi.

17. atha kho ānanda, nimi rājā kappakassa gāmava-
raṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ āmantāpetvā etada-
voca: 'pātubhūtā kho me tāta kumāra devadūtā, dis-
santi sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, bhuttā kho pana me mā-
nusakā kāmā, samayo dibbe kāme pariyesituṃ. ehi
tvam tāta kumāra, imaṃ rajjaṃ paṭipajja. ahaṃ pana
kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā
agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajissāmi. tena hi tāta ku-
māra, yadā tvampi passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni jā-
tāni, atha kappakassa gāmavaraṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ
kumāraṃ sādhuṃ rajje samanūsāsivā kesamassuṃ
ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā ana-
gāriyaṃ pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭ-
ṭaṃ nihitaṃ anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho me tvam an-
timapuriso ahoṣi. yasmiṃ kho tāta kumāra, purisa-
yuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa sa-
muccheda hoti so tesam antimapuriso hoti. taṃ tā-
haṃ tāta kumāra, evaṃ vadāmi: 'yena me idaṃ ka-
lyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho me
tvam antimapuriso ahoṣī'ti.

lunar fortnight.” We the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, wish to see you. Take delight, O great king, in divine power among the devas.” Enough, dear sir, lead me back just there to Mithila. There I will fare by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observe the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.” So then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed Matali, the charioteer: “Come you good Matali, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, lead king Nimi back just there to Mithila.” “Yes Lord,” O Ananda, Matali, the charioteer, having replied to Sakka, ruler of the devas, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, led king Nimi back just there to Mithila.

17. Just there, O Ananda, king Nimi fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Nimi addressed his barber: “when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform me.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber replied to king Nimi. Then from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, O Ananda, the barber saw that

18. atha kho ānanda, nimi rājā kappakassa gāmava-
 raṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ sādhukaṃ rajje sa-
 manusāsivā imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane kesa-
 massuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agā-
 rasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbaji. so mettāsahagatena ce-
 tasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, ta-
 thā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ
 sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantāṃ lokaṃ mettāsa-
 hagatena cetasaṃ vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena
 averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi. karuṇāsahaga-
 tena cetasaṃ -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasaṃ -pe- upek-
 khāsahagatena cetasaṃ ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, ta-
 thā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddha-
 madho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantāṃ
 lokaṃ upekkhāsahagatena cetasaṃ vipulena mahagga-
 tena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vi-
 hāsi.

19. nimi kho paṇānanda, rājā caturāsītivassasahas-
 sāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīḷi, caturāsītivassasahassāni opa-
 rajjaṃ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjaṃ kāresi,
 caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva makhādevam-
 bavane agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajito brahmacari-
 yaṃ cari. so cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa
 bhedaṃ parammaraṇā brahmalokūpago ahosi. nimissa
 kho paṇānananda, rañño kalārajanako nāma putto ahosi.
 so na agāasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbaji. so taṃ kalyā-
 ṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ samucchindi. so tesāṃ antimapuriso ahosi.

grey hairs have emerged on king Nimi's head. Having seen, he said this to king Nimi: "The divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on your head." "Well then good barber, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in my cupped hand." "Yes, your majesty," O Ananda, the barber having replied to king Nimi, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in king Nimi's cupped hand.

17. Then, O Ananda, king Nimi, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: "My son prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such

20. siyā kho pana te ānanda, evamassa: añño nūna tena samayena rājā makhādevo ahosi yena¹ taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitanti.² na kho panetaṃ ānanda, evaṃ datṭhabbaṃ. ahaṃ tena samayena rājā makhādevo ahosiṃ. ahaṃ taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiniṃ.³ mayā taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ pacchimā janatā anuppavattesi. taṃ kho panānanda, kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ na nibbidāya na virāgāya na nirodhāya na upasamāya na abhiññāya na sambodhāya na nibbānāya saṃvattati, yāvadeva brahmalokūpapattiyā.

21. idaṃ kho panānanda, etarahi mayā kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati. katamā cānanda, etarahi mayā kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati: ayameva ariyo aṭṭhaṅgiko maggo. seyyathīdaṃ: sammādiṭṭhi sammāsaṅkappo sammāvācā sammākammanto sammāājīvo sammāvāyāmo sammāsati sammāsamādhi. idaṃ kho ānanda, etarahi mayā kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati. taṃ vo ahaṃ ānanda, evaṃ vadāmi: yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ anuppavatteyyātha, mā kho me tumhe antimapurisā ahuvattha. yasmिṃ kho ānanda, purisayuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa samucchedo hoti so tesam antimapuriso hoti. taṃ vo ahaṃ ānanda, evaṃ vadāmi: yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ anuppavatteyyātha. mā kho me tumhe

a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you my son prince, say thus: "Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man."

18. Then, O Ananda, king Nimi having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kindom, in this Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

19. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Nimi amused himself with children games. For

antimapurisā ahuvatthā'ti. idamavoca bhagavā attamano āyasmā ānando bhagavato bhāsitam abhinandīti.

eighty four thousand years he occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on to the brahma world. King Nimi's son, O Ananda, was named Kalarajanaka. He did not go forth from the home life into homelessness. He cut off that good custom. He was the last man of those.

20. Now it might be, O Ananda, that it occurs to you thus: Surely some other person was king Makhadeva who laid down that good custom at that time. But this should not be seen thus. I was king Makhadeva at that time. I laid down that good custom. That good custom laid down by me was continued in succession by later generation. However, O Ananda, that good custom did not lead to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowlege, to supreme awakening, to nibbana, [but] only for arising in the brahma world.

21. However, at present, O Ananda, this good custom laid down by me lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowlege, to supreme awakening, to nibbana." And what at present, O Ananda, is that good custom laid down by me which lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation,

to peace, to supreme knowlege, to supreme awakening, to nibbana? It is just this noble eight-fold path. That is, right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, right samadhi. This, at present, O Ananda, is that good custom laid down by me which lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowlege, to supreme awakening, to nibbana. That I to you all, O Ananda, say thus: "Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let none of you be my last man." Among a pair of individuals existing, O Ananda, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you all, O Ananda, say thus: "Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let none of you be my last man." This is what the Auspicious One said. Delighted, the venerable Ananda rejoiced in the Auspicious One's words.

